

SHASA Newsletter February/March 2025

Is it still worth buying a rooftop solar system? (1)

Recent years have seen a rapid decline in feed-in tariffs for electricity put back into the grid from household rooftop solar systems. A quick check of retailers shows between 5c and 10c per kWh on the South Coast. Most households with a large rooftop solar system consume between 30% and 50% of the solar electricity they generate.

Size of solar system	Cost of solar system	Electricity savings p.a.	Feed-in tariff p.a.	Total savings	Payback
8kW	\$8000 (approx.)	\$1022	\$182	\$1204	6.64 years

The more solar electricity you can consume, the bigger the savings. For example, an electric car uses 16–18kWh per 100km. If you charge your car using the excess solar electricity, it will only cost you the feed-in tariff.

Kathryn Maxwell, President of SHASA, owns an MG4 with a 64 kWh battery. It costs her \$3.20 for 400+ km of driving. Switch all appliances to electric (save on expensive gas bottles and fees) and use timers to operate during the day to add to your savings.

You will be able to smile when your electricity bills arrive in your letterbox or inbox.

To ensure a quality install, we recommend local Bodalla business Micro Energy Systems (MESA). They have done a fantastic job with all of SHASA's community facility solar installs and they help to fund SHASA's work.

Give Lisa a call on 0410 790 616.



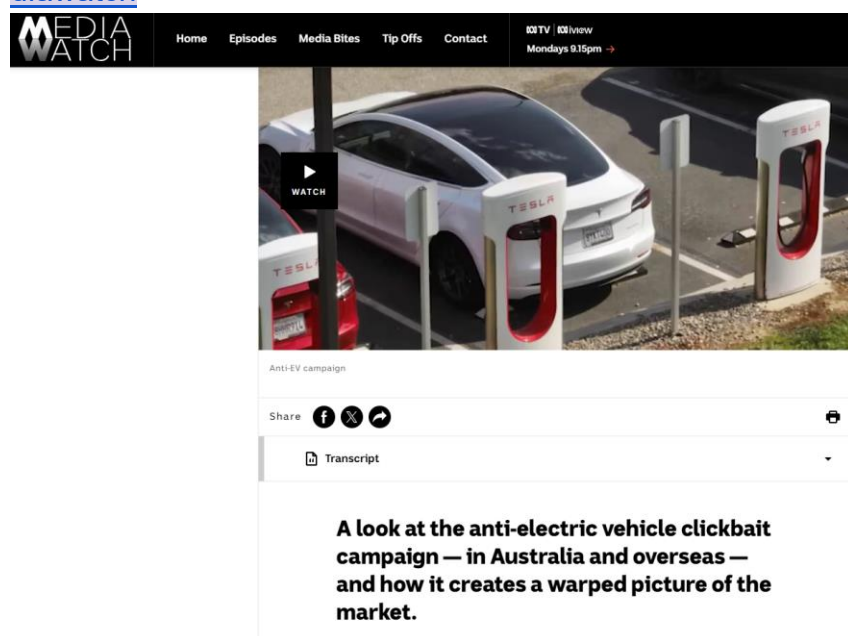
Solar install in the Eurobodalla

Traditional vehicle and fossil fuel industry working hard to discredit EVs (2)

“Persistent misconceptions include exaggerated concerns about battery life, charging infrastructure and safety. Traditional vehicle and oil companies actively spread misinformation in campaigns much like those used against other green energy initiatives.” (Canberra City News 16–22 January 2025).

ABC’s Media Watch program, which exposes media bias and poor reporting, showed that the anti-EV coverage is co-ordinated, widespread, and based on poor, or cherry-picked research. That’s a flag for a PR campaign in progress.

https://www.abc.net.au/mediawatch/episodes/evs/104128046?utm_campaign=abcmediawatch&utm_content=link&utm_medium=content_shared&utm_source=abcmediawatch



The benefits of EVs are known to those of us who drive them, but they can be swamped by these negative stories. Contrary to the fossil fuel industry’s PR, EVs are actually:

1. much **cheaper to run**, especially if you charge using rooftop solar. It's more than 10x cheaper to charge at home than at a fast charger. You only use fast chargers when travelling long distances.
2. extremely **cheap to maintain** — no combustion engine causing damage to vehicle parts, no gearbox, very few moving parts
3. **clean** — they do not emit toxic fumes into the air, thus greatly reducing very harmful air pollution
4. **quiet** — so quiet they have to ping when backing to warn pedestrians to keep clear
5. more **efficient** — they do not waste energy in producing unwanted heat, as a combustion engine does
6. very **nippy** — EVs have excellent acceleration

7. much **easier to drive**
8. **safer** — they are less likely to have accidents because of modern driver assistance technology on board
9. An EV has a much, **much lower chance of catching fire than a combustion vehicle**. Really.
10. Have batteries that last a long time.

A new study released by Australian used car marketplace Pickles shows that electric vehicles maintain more than 90 per cent of their battery health, even after 120,000 kilometres and more than four years on the road.

It challenges common fears about EV battery degradation, which are cited as one of the biggest barriers to purchasing an EV. One 2023 [report](#) from the Green Finance Institute found 62 per cent of the respondents said they would not purchase an EV because of concerns about battery lifespan.

Hyundai EVs showed an impressive 99.31 per cent battery health after 120,000 kms, while BYD was a close second at 98.62 per cent, exceeding Tesla's previous record.

EVENTS — Earth Hour @ the Botanic Gardens (3)

SHASA and Eurobodalla Shire Council are celebrating Earth Hour with an evening at the Eurobodalla Regional Botanic Gardens. Check out eventbrite for more information and to book your spot.

[Earth Hour: energy and solar at home tickets, Sat, Mar 22, 2025 at 5:00 PM | Eventbrite](#)

EVENTS — Sustainable House Day — 4 May 2025 (4)

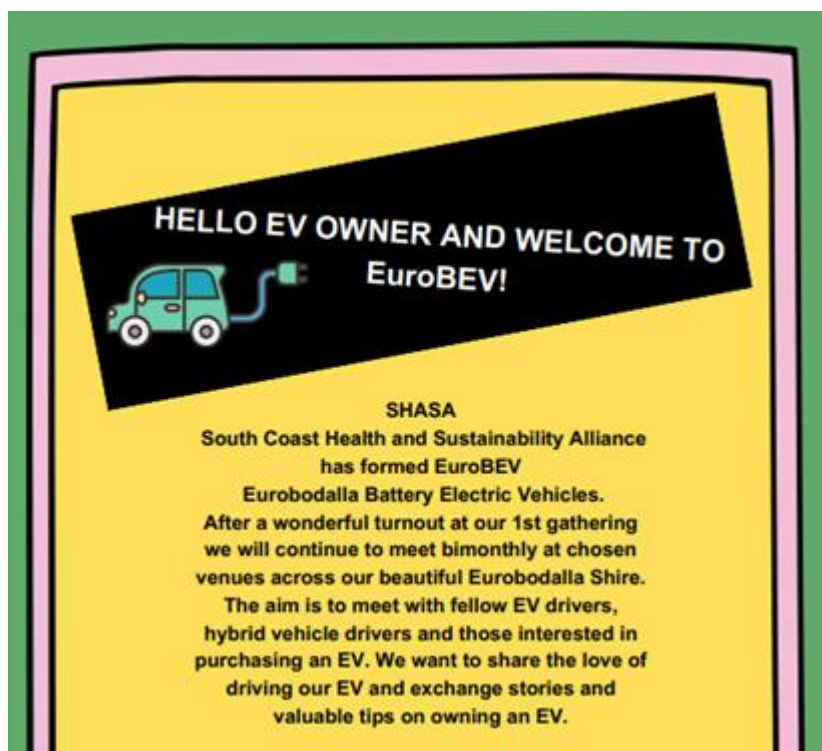
Have you built or retrofitted a house with elements of sustainability? Maybe you've gone off gas, added solar, re-glazed? Or gone the whole way, and built using sustainable materials. Many people want to know how it was done — they would love to hear YOUR story!

Consider opening your home to the public on Sustainable House Day. You need to [register online](#) by Sunday 23rd February... so get a wriggle on!

Council will once again support the event, and you can contact Sustainability Projects Officer, Kirsten Pitot, for council-related questions. Renew is the authority to contact for SHD questions.

E: Kirsten.Pitot@esc.nsw.gov.au

EVENTS — Eurobodalla Battery Electric Vehicle Lunch (EuroBEV) (4)



Sorry, but...

EuroBEV meeting postponed to 23rd February (*it was planned for 9 February*). We'll meet at noon for lunch at the lovely Mossy Point cafe. Please RSVP to andrew.john.everard@gmail.com. We love to chat with you about the pleasures and issues of driving electric.

Enhancing your telecommunications — Tec Talk 12 March 2025 — Trish Pye (5) – Kathryn to provide details?

**WOULD YOU LIKE TO HAVE ACCESS
TO RELIABLE INTERNET
WHERE YOU LIVE ?**

**You could win a Starlink Satellite Internet
Package which includes a satellite dish to
ensure fast internet guaranteed for a full year !**



**The Tec Exec are teaming up with SHASA
to offer the opportunity to win a 12 month
Starlink Satellite Internet Package.
Scan the QR Code to find out more.**



EVENTS — SHASA mini-Expo 16 March Batemans Bay Markets (6)

Could you spare an hour or so to help out on SHASA's stall at the Batemans Bay Markets on Sunday 16 March?

It's always fun to get together with other SHASA members, talk to interested locals and visitors, and spread the word about electric vehicles, solar panels and batteries, community activities, and the low-carbon lifestyle. We'll set up from 8am, and bump out at between 12 and 1pm. If you can help, please contact Kathryn or Andrea at SHASA.

We'd love to have a few electric cars for people to look at — it's a good way to start a conversation with an interested person. SHASA can arrange for test drives, too. Do you have an EV to show off?



[CAPTION: SHASA's pioneering EV owners braved the chill winter for the first EV meeting in 2022]



[CAPTION: Narooma EV Expo 2024]

A Safer Future for Eurobodalla's Youngest Residents (7)

During the 2019–20 Black Summer bushfires, families in Eurobodalla faced immense challenges protecting their infants and young children. Pregnant women, babies, and toddlers were among the most vulnerable, yet a lack of targeted disaster planning left families struggling with unsafe evacuation centers, limited support, and long-term health risks. Recognizing this gap, the Australian Breastfeeding Association (ABA) launched the Community Protection for Infants and Young Children in Bushfire Emergencies Project (ABA Bushfire Project) in 2022, funded by the Australian Government.

Local families played a key role in shaping this initiative. Insights from the Babies and Young Children in the Black Summer (BiBS) Study highlighted the need for better preparedness and resources for families with young children. This led to the development of tools like evacuation kit checklists, breastfeeding guides, emergency animations, and training modules for responders. Families and emergency services in Eurobodalla collaborated to refine these resources, ensuring they addressed real needs on the ground.

While significant progress has been made, the ABA Bushfire Project continues to advocate for better emergency planning and funding to establish Mother Baby Areas. Its success has gained national recognition, inspiring other regions and organisations to adopt similar strategies. For more information about the project and resources, visit [ABA's website](#).

The ABA Bushfire Project Team would like to invite SHASA members to join them in celebrating the project's achievements at their end-of-project celebration at the Botanical Gardens on Thursday, February 27, from 5:30–7:00 PM. Please RSVP by February 13 using the following link:

https://forms.office.com/pages/responsepage.aspx?id=2WPrWF6FhEqITjnhSL_0U0CcNNMNtlxLgpN0Zpo5nytUQUZGVIM5NIUzREtEU1I0UTZLSTc1RzE1Ui4u&route=shorturl

Australian Breastfeeding Association
invites you to the
**The Bushfire Project's closing
event**

**Date**

Thursday 27th February
2025

5:30pm - 6:30pm

Location

Banksia Room,
Eurobodalla Botanic
Gardens

Details

Join us for nibbles and
drinks as we share our
project's success in the
local community and
beyond.

RSVP Please RSVP by 13th of
February by scanning
QR code.



**Australian
Breastfeeding
Association**

This event is part of the Community Protection for Infants and Young Children in Bushfire Emergencies Project.
This project received funding from the Australian Government.

Do you use a council-owned facility that needs an upgrade? (8)

SHASA is partnering with the Eurobodalla Shire Council to apply for energy upgrades to council-owned, community-accessed buildings under the [Community Buildings Partnership Grant](#). If you are a community group wanting to improve your local club house, hall, function centre or other facility, please register your interest with Sustainability Supervisor, Alex King. The grants will be available in both 2025 and 2026.

E: alexandra.king@esc.nsw.gov.au

Cutting energy costs in your business (9)

As a business owner, you might be hearing the growing chatter about power purchase agreements (PPAs). But what are they, and why should you consider one?

Power Purchase Agreements (PPAs) guarantee stable electricity prices and support new renewable energy capacity. Negotiating the perfect contract can be tricky, and Council is providing a series of information sessions in February/March 2025 to help you find your way.

Register your interest with Council's Sustainability Projects Officer, Kirsten Pitot:

E: Kirsten.Pitot@esc.nsw.gov.au

For all your local news and community events subscribe free to the Moruya Mail at www.moruyamail.com.au or hello@moruyamail.com.au You will receive a comprehensive newspaper electronically every Wednesday.

Tilba Halls Project Update (10)



Tilba Halls Committee: Tony Lowe (SHASA Project Manager), Sally Pryor (Secretary Central Tilba School of Arts Trust f), Stephanie Chiu (our architect and Proj Mgr + SHASA), Janine Halasz (President Central Tilba School of Arts Trust f), Stuart Absalom and Pete Phillips (both SHASA)

A very happy project team at Tilba celebrated the start of building work on Tilba's twin Halls in December 2024. The project will deliver new facilities, including a commercial kitchen, designated meeting room, and storage area and increase capacity to 100 people.

The upgrade and extension project was planned 20 years ago, but funding wasn't available. In June 2021 SHASA and the Committee were awarded \$1.048 million from the Federal and NSW governments' Bushfire Local Economic Recovery Fund (BLERF).

Costs increased markedly over the three year planning and approval process (to \$3.03 million) from the initial budget, but the funding body has accepted that the resulting upgrade will reduce costs, improve essential safety and provide much better community resources for Tilba's residents and the surrounding area.

From SHASA's point of view, the essential improvements include solar panels, batteries and an emergency power generator so the halls can operate during emergencies, plus a lift from

upstairs so that the new toilet facilities downstairs can meet accessibility standards. There will also be a fire booster pump for the sprinkler system that will be in a separate enclosure. With these facilities in place, residents of the National Trust villages of Central Tilba and Tilba Tilba have a heatwave and bushfire smoke haven in the downstairs meeting room. Our congratulations to this hard-working and effective project team.

TUROSS HEAD PROGRESS ASSOCIATION (THPA) (11)

HEALTH FUNDING AND ACCESS - FAIRNESS FOR THE FAR SOUTH COAST (FSC)

2025 FEDERAL ELECTION – CALL FOR COMMUNITY ACTION

For the FAR SOUTH COAST the THPA is demanding that all candidates for the 2025 Federal election in Eden-Monaro and Gilmore commit to:

1. fix the lack of access to healthcare in the FSC caused by 40 years of neglect by successive governments
2. guarantee equality in healthcare funding on a per person basis in FSC communities, when compared to city populations
3. fix the current healthcare financing system which has significantly disadvantaged rural communities for 40 years
4. focus the initial funding on increased access to medical care in each township, to be delivered by teams of additional GPs and associated primary care providers

Why should SHASA support our demands?

SHASA, like all Volunteer Community Organisations, is the last line of defence for their communities when they don't get treated fairly by governments. Access to healthcare is a major community issue impacting everyone, young and old. The 2025 federal election is the last and best chance to fix 40 years of neglect in healthcare by all political parties.

Background

THPA has had enough of neglect by successive governments, to the lack of fairness in funding and access to healthcare in the FSC. We won't put up with another 40 years of higher rates of premature deaths and delayed access to care for serious illness.

The underfunding for rural communities compared to cities was reported in the 2023 National Rural Health Alliance NOUS REPORT at \$1,000 per person (2025 estimate adjusted for inflation). This is approx. \$83 million per year over the Far South Coast or nearly \$1 billion over the past two governments.

Outcomes for the Far South Coast if candidate elected to government:

1. the first budget to fund the FSC annual shortfall of \$1,000 per person
2. to achieve similar access to general practice and primary care as a city population

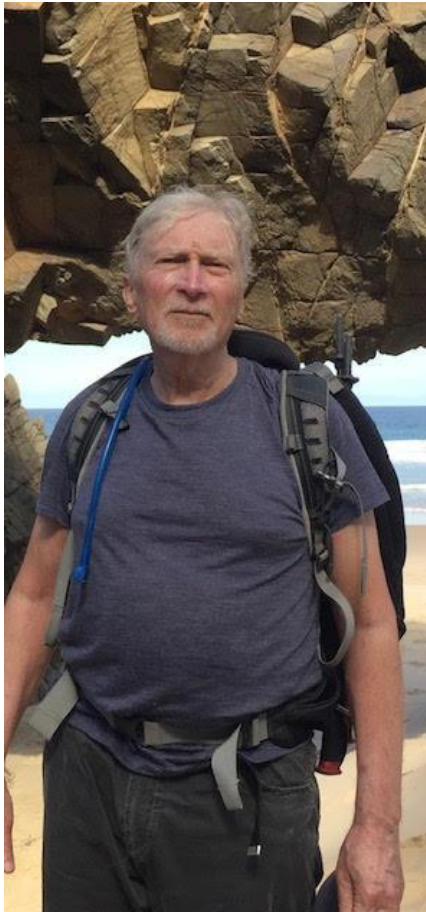
3. to deliver services which specifically meet the needs of individual communities.
4. to have decision making on services made at the local community/GP team level
5. to eliminate bureaucratic barriers so GPs/ primary care providers can focus on patient care
6. to eliminate the very large delayed and unmet need for medical care
7. to reduce GP waiting times to 'same day' for urgent care and 'within 2 days' for routine care for all patients
8. to establish GP and primary care provider team arrangements to improve care
9. to remove patient cost as a barrier for first point of contact GP care

WHAT TO DO NEXT?

Support by individuals and community organisations is the only way to get political action on fair access and funding for healthcare. Don't wait another 40 years. Add your support now!

SUPPORT THE THPA'S 2025 HEALTH CAMPAIGN - CLICK THE LINK

<https://www.thpa.com.au/health-2025>



Dr. Arn Sprogis retired rural GP and Chairman of the Tuross Head Progress Association Health Subcommittee.

Update on implementation of the 2022 SHASA Bushfire and Heatwave Haven Strategy for the Eurobodalla (12)

In partnership with community organisations that run facilities, SHASA has undertaken upgrades on seven buildings so far:

- Red Door Hall, Anglican Parish (solar, batteries, air conditioning, blinds, insulation, kitchen upgrade)
- Moruya PreSchool Kindergarten (solar, batteries, backup generator, pump, fire hoses)
- CWA Moruya (solar, batteries, backup gas generator, air conditioning, HEPA filters, electrical upgrade, LED lighting and window shutters)
- CWA Narooma (new roof, insulation, solar, batteries, new flooring, kitchen upgrade, window shutters)
- Uniting Church Catalina (solar, batteries, backup generators, HEPA filters, accessible toilet, washing machine, fridges, shelving, replacement of gas heaters with air conditioners)

- Anglican Church Batemans Bay (electrical upgrade, LED lighting, solar, and batteries)
- Moruya Surf Club (solar batteries, backup generator, LED lighting, air conditioning and filters)

SHASA is currently seeking grant funding to upgrade the following buildings:

- Southern Life Church Moruya
- Broulee Surf Club
- Anglican Parish Batemans Bay (Stage 3)

SHASA believes it is time to update the strategy to a Community Resilience Strategy and add facilities that need just solar and batteries to reduce their electricity costs. If you know of a community building that may benefit from SHASA's assistance, please send an email with details to contact.shasa@gmail.com

Batemans Bay and District Heatwave and Bushfire Havens

Key To Map Symbols

-  National Park
-  Population centre
-  Hospital
-  Heatwave and Bushfire Havens
-  Evacuation Centre
-  Members only
-  SkyFi available

Havens

Batemans Bay Uniting Church
2 Catlin Ave Batemans Bay
02 44726098

Batemans Bay Anglican Church
6 Herarde St Batemans Bay
02 44725822

Evacuation Centre

Batemans Bay
Basketball Stadium
Beach Road
Batemans Bay

This map shows the general location of Heatwave and Bushfire Havens as at the date of publication. It is not intended to be used for navigation and users rely on this map at their own risk.

Edition 14 December 2024



SHASA
Southcoast Health and Sustainability Alliance

The Southcoast Health and Sustainability Alliance (SHASA) is an alliance of Eurobodalla community members.

shasa.com.au  0467 558 645



Moruya and District Heatwave and Bushfire Havens

Key To Map Symbols

-  National Park
-  Population centre
-  Hospital
-  Heatwave and Bushfire Havens
-  Evacuation Centre
-  Members only
-  SkyFi available
-  Evacuation on foot
-  Road closed since Nov 2021

Havens

Red Door Hall
St Johns Commons
50 Campbell St Moruya
(via Page St)
anglican.moruya@gmail.com
02 44740300
SkyFi available

Moruya CWA
64 Queen St Moruya
moruyacwa@outlook.com.au

Moruya Preschool
15 Campbell St Moruya
moruyapreschool@southernphone.com.au

Moruya Surf Club
2 Charles Moffitt Drive
Moruya Heads
info@moruyasurf.org.au

This map shows the general location of Heatwave and Bushfire Havens as at the date of publication. It is not intended to be used for navigation and users rely on this map at their own risk.

Edition 14 December 2024



SHASA
Southcoast Health and Sustainability Alliance

The Southcoast Health and Sustainability Alliance (SHASA) is an alliance of Eurobodalla community members.

shasa.com.au  0467 558 645



Narooma and District Heatwave and Bushfire Havens

Key To Map Symbols

-  National Park
-  Population centre
-  Hospital
-  Heatwave and Bushfire Havens
-  Evacuation Centre
-  Members only
-  SkyFi available

Havens

Narooma Mens Shed
41A Barker Parade Narooma
naroomamensshed@gmail.com

Narooma CWA
96 Princes Hwy Narooma
cwa.narooma@gmail.com

Evacuation Centre

Narooma Leisure Centre
100 Bluewater Dr Narooma

This map shows the general location of Heatwave and Bushfire Havens as at the date of publication. It is not intended to be used for navigation and users rely on this map at their own risk.

Edition 14 December 2024



SHASA
Southcoast Health and Sustainability Alliance

The Southcoast Health and Sustainability Alliance (SHASA) is an alliance of Eurobodalla community members.

shasa.com.au  0467 558 645



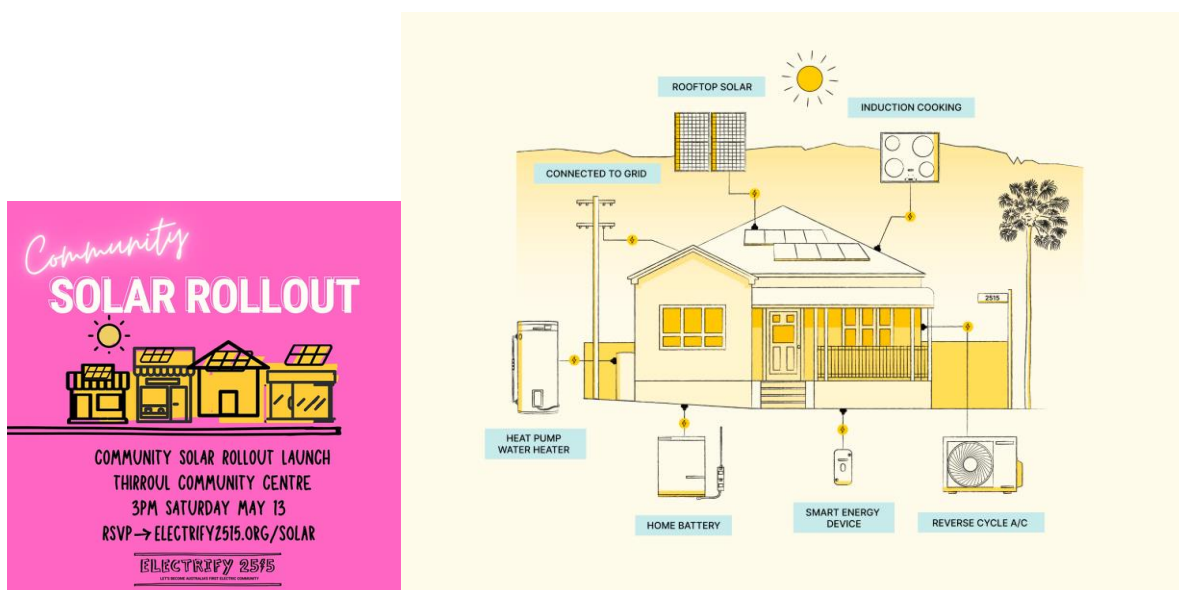


Australian Government
Australian Renewable
Energy Agency

ARENA

ARENA (Australian Renewable Energy Agency) funding restored following success of 2515 (postcode) trial to electrify households (13)

Electrify 2515 is delivering energy-efficient electric appliances and consumer energy resources in participating homes in the suburbs of Austinmer, Clifton, Coledale, Scarborough, Thirroul and Wombarra, near Wollongong in New South Wales, along with a smart energy management device to help customers to manage their own electricity use.



[CAPTION: Thirroul rollout of 2515 trial - community launch poster.]

CAPTION image 2: Replacing outdated appliances with new, efficient electric ones, allows households to manage when they use and charge devices and delivers savings]

Good News - The initial reports of the savings and convenience delivered by the pilot project have encouraged other communities to welcome possible pilot projects near them. At the end of 2024, the Government made ARENA responsible for supporting community electrification and also restored ARENA's funding, which the previous government did not renew.

Federal Minister for Climate Change and Energy Chris Bowen asked ARENA to fund more community electrification demonstration projects across the country. ARENA is now seeking more opportunities to spread the Electrify 2515 pilot beyond NSW, across the ACT, Western Australia, Queensland, Victoria and Tasmania. The funding could help thousands of households, including renters, secure their homes from bill shock with more solar, batteries, energy efficient appliances and shared community energy storage.

This is the first time Minister Bowen has used the statutory ministerial referral powers to ask the ARENA board to look at backing specific projects. ARENA looks at each proposed project on merit, so communities will need to apply for consideration.

“ARENA pilot projects supporting home electrification will help create valuable insights into how households can transition to renewables and smart energy systems to cut energy costs and reduce emissions,” said Chris Bowen. “I’d like to thank senators David Pocock, David Van, Jacqui Lambie and Lidia Thorpe for their ongoing advocacy for cheaper, cleaner energy to run homes and their commitment to renewable energy.”

SHASA Resilience Awards - (14)



Joslyn Van Der Moolan and Lyn Smith with the 2024 SHASA resilience awards poster at Art on the Path, Broulee

SHASA has 3 new stickers. (15)

You can pick up stickers at our stalls — the next one will be at the Batemans Bay Market on Sunday 16 February. Or send your request with your address to contact.shasa@gmail.com and we will post them to you.

Working together for a cleaner, smarter future



SHASA
Southcoast Health and Sustainability Alliance



shasa.com.au



A better future for the Eurobodalla



SHASA
Southcoast Health and Sustainability Alliance



shasa.com.au



Community resilience for the Eurobodalla



SHASA
Southcoast Health and Sustainability Alliance



shasa.com.au



Forests update (16)

March in March for Forests

Sun 23 March 2025

It's time to end native forest logging

**Ulladulla, Bega, Canberra, Sydney
Bellingen, Northern Rivers, Newcastle
Melbourne, Hobart, Adelaide**

More locations to be announced

Sign up <https://marchforforests.org/>

11am Rally Ulladulla Civic Centre Lawns

10am stalls, ice creams, facepainting

12 Noon March for the forests

**1.30pm Takayna Film Screening Ulladulla Civic
Centre Lower Auditorium \$15 Tix**

<https://takayna.org/screening/ulladulla-screening/>

Bob Brown Foundation

Listen to our political representatives outline this plan to secure full protection of our NSW public forests. Forest wildlife needs a permanent end to logging to recover from the devastation of the Black Summer fires. Protecting native forests creates biodiverse carbon storage to buffer runaway global heating. Local mountain bike trails in Mogo will

be protected from logging, which will boost international ecotourism in our area, including the upcoming [Sea Otter Classic](#).

[Moruya Mail](#) A plan to end native forest logging in NSW and create the Great Southern Forest National Park was announced by the Greens at the Eurobodalla Botanic Gardens on 30 January 2025 (with videos of speeches).

30 Jan 2025 [Greens Promise \\$140 million dollars per Year to End Native Forest Logging](#). 31 Jan 2025, ABC SE Facebook, [ABC 6.30am News Radio Clip](#)

30 Jan 2025 [Greens plan to end native forest logging by taxing big business](#) Batemans Bay Post (paywalled)

30 Jan 2025 <https://www.begadistrictnews.com.au/story/8880122/greens-propose-tax-on-big-business-for-forest-protection/>

BDN (also paywalled)

A great time to get involved with SHASA (17) = OMITTED DUE TO SPACE

“The media exaggerates negative news. This distortion has consequences.”

- Stephen Pinker, Enlightenment Now, 2018.



📷 'The nature of news is likely to distort people's view of the world.' Illustration: Sam Morris

Don't get overwhelmed by all the bad news, good news, fake news, breaking news, fact-free news — break the cycle and join SHASA! Be part of a group! Work on

projects to reduce emissions in the Eurobodalla, and help us become more resilient. It's only \$5. You can join via the SHASA website www.shasa.com.au

The **Repurposing for Resilience [RfR]** team is back from break and en route for what promises to be another busy and productive year!

The RfR solar reuse centre is back to normal operating hours on a Friday and Saturday from 9.30am - 2.30pm

Drop into the transfer station to:

- Access free advice & assistance from volunteer electrical / solar contractors [Fridays 9.30-11.30]
- Shop used equipment and waste art online via www.rfreurobodalla.com.au
- Meet members of the volunteer team responsible for operating this first of a kind centre, and talk about membership, services and upcoming workshops over a cuppa in the alfresco area..all built from waste!
- Take a seat under the new shade structure installed during the holidays, providing much needed protection from the harsh elements
- Look out for the community access solar power trailer which will be dishing up the food and bev goods shortly at Cobargo Folk Festival and then Councils Earth hour, inside the beautiful Regional Botanical Garden

RfR - be part of the solution...



